

Face-2-Face with practitioner

“My role in this company is that of an astrologer, I answer questions for clients and predict future scenarios based on numbers from the past.”

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Transportation analytics, while covered more extensively in the field of operations research, seeks to minimise route length, fuel costs or fare pricing.

❑ Online or web site Analytics

Web site analytics focuses on analysing traffic to the web site and how to retain visitors on the web site for a longer time or encourage them to purchase more goods. It also involves a bit of search engine optimisation to make sure the web site is high up in the results provided by search engines.

What is your career path as an Analytic?

Typically, everyone starts with an analyst role. It starts with analysing operational data. As the analyst grows in the organisation and gains business acumen, he is then capable of getting into business analytics. The analyst would then have opportunity to become a consultant with firms like McKinsey or Boston Consulting Group.

Career progression in analytics follows the broad pattern as follows:

❑ **Fresher:** As an entry-level programmer or analyst, you would be required to write code to generate reports, or clean data to prepare it for analysis. You would also be expected to pick-up nuances of business data, what data is usually wrong, what are the outliers to spot, besides learning the programming language to retrieve and manipulate data. This phase could last for up to two years. As you grow, you will also assist in recruiting and training freshers.

❑ **Experienced Analyst:** For a period of three to five years of relevant experience, you would then be working as a Senior Analyst / Assistant Manager with official duties in data analysis with some people responsibilities. Depending on your aptitude and organizational abilities, you can tweak the level of business exposure, people management with the amount of technical analysis / skills.

❑ **Managerial Roles:** After a period of up to five years, you would be full-time dealing directly with clients, people management, requirements gathering, and translation to technical details for your team. This will also involve recruiting, mentoring junior members and technical training.

❑ **Head (Analytics) / Associate Vice President / Business Leaders:** You can expect to be a business leader within eight to ten years of full experience. The focus will be to grow your team size, maximise customer satisfaction, and deliver innovative analytics that positively impact business revenues.

Why did I choose this career?

It happened! I did not plan to get into this career but it was the first job I took. However, I can tell you the reasons that have made me stick to it.

- **Scope of learning:** This career poses a new scope to learn every day. Different clients have different set of queries to be answered. This gives a new perspective and unmatched knowledge exposure.
- **Exercising the mind:** I know my mind still works. Working with numbers gives me a high. It lets the mind draw inferences on different situations and come up with smart answers.
- **Creativity:** This career has allowed me to use my creativity to unleash the power of numbers that is hidden in the volumes of data given to us.
- **Culture** – The culture of the organisation is professional and healthy,